

ERFAN SHAHABI

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Research Interests

Natural Language Processing, Large Language Models, Strategic Reasoning and Behavior of LLMs, Social Intelligence, Computational Social Science, Machine Behavior

Education

M.Sc in Information Technology Engineering, GPA: 4.00/4.00 (17.76/20)

*Sep 2024 – Present
Tehran, Iran*

University of Tehran, School of ECE

- Supervisors: [Dr. Azadeh Shakery](#), [Dr. Yadollah Yaghoobzadeh](#)
- Thesis: An Investigation and Enhancement of Strategic Behavior of Large Language Models in Social Context

B.Sc in Industrial Engineering, GPA: 4.00/4.00 (18.07/20)

*Sep 2019 – Aug 2023
Tehran, Iran*

Islamic Azad University, Science and Research Branch

- Supervisor: [Dr. Abbas Saghaei](#)
- Thesis: Used Car Price Prediction Using Machine Learning Methods

Publications

- **AuDiPE: Behavior-Grounded User Simulation via Audited Dialogue-based Profile Enrichment for Conversational Recommender Systems**

Under Review at NAACL 2027 Conference (recommended for Findings in ARR May 2026 cycle) [🔗](#)

A Roshandel*, [E Shahabi](#)*, MS Sadeghi, A Shakery (*equal contribution, ordered randomly)

- **PerSo: Evaluating Social Intelligence of LLMs using Real-World Persuasion Scenarios**

Under Review at NAACL 2027 Conference [🔗](#)

A Zamani, S Esfahanian, [E Shahabi](#), MT Pilehvar, A Shakery, Y Yaghoobzadeh

Professional Experience

Researcher

Intelligent Information Systems Lab

*Sep 2024 – Present
ECE @ University of Tehran,
Tehran, Iran*

- Supervisors: [Dr. Azadeh Shakery](#), [Dr. Yadollah Yaghoobzadeh](#)
- Research Area: Strategic Behavior and Social Reasoning of LLMs
- Developed **PerSo**, a benchmark evaluating social intelligence of LLMs using real-world persuasion scenarios from Reddit's Change My View (CMV) community
- Built a behavior-grounded user simulation framework (**AuDiPE**) for conversational recommender systems, leveraging audited synthetic interviews to enrich user profiles

AI Engineer / Data Scientist

Potk.ir

*Jul 2026 – Present
Tehran, Iran*

- Built data analysis and forecasting pipelines to predict market trends in electrical cable purchasing and sales
- Developed AI-powered tools leveraging LLMs and information retrieval techniques to support business decision-making

AI Engineer

Mofid Stock Brokerage

*Feb 2026 – Jul 2026
Tehran, Iran*

- Developing AI-powered financial tools leveraging LLMs and information retrieval techniques

Leadership Experience

Supervised 2 Bachelor Students for Research Project

Intelligent Information Systems Lab

*Mar 2026 – Aug 2026
ECE @ University of Tehran,
Tehran, Iran*

- Supervised undergraduate research on LLM social intelligence evaluation
- Resulted in a paper submission to ACL ARR Aug 2026 cycle

Teaching Experience

Head Teaching Assistant, Intelligent Information Retrieval (Graduate)

Sep 2026 – Present

Course Website · Instructor: [Dr. Azadeh Shakery](#)

ECE @ University of Tehran

- Coordinated 6 computer assignments, workshops & the paper presentation module with a team of 6 TAs

Teaching Assistant, Natural Language Processing (Graduate)

Sep 2025 – Present

Course Website · Instructor: [Dr. Heshaam Faili](#)

ECE @ University of Tehran

- Designed TravelBot assignment: a conversational travel assistant using ReAct architecture and LangGraph for flight search, hotel booking, and trip planning
- Implemented RAG pipeline for retrieving destination information and generating personalized travel recommendations
- Led workshops mentoring students on LangChain and LangGraph frameworks for building agent-based systems

Teaching Assistant, Intelligent Information Retrieval (Graduate)

Sep 2025 – Sep 2026

Course Website · Instructor: [Dr. Azadeh Shakery](#)

ECE @ University of Tehran

- Designed assignments on conversational search, RAG systems, and multi-agent architectures
- Conducted workshops on probability theory and machine learning foundations for information retrieval
- Led technical workshops on LLMs in IR, covering LangChain, LangGraph, and ReAct patterns
- Guided students in implementing practical retrieval systems using state-of-the-art language models

Teaching Assistant, Advanced Data Mining (Graduate)

Feb 2026 – Present

Instructor: [Dr. Azadeh Shakery](#)

ECE @ University of Tehran

- Designed GNN-based assignment on academic network analysis, where students predict paper authorship and inter-paper relationships using graph neural networks
- Conducted hands-on workshops on GNN architectures and their applications in network data mining

Teaching Assistant, Natural Language Processing (Graduate)

Feb 2026 – Present

Instructor: [Dr. Yadollah Yaghoobzadeh](#)

ECE @ University of Tehran

- Designed and managed a financial advisory chatbot assignment, guiding students in building domain-specific conversational agents using LLMs
- Led workshops on fine-tuning and prompt engineering for task-specific NLP applications

Selected Projects

- Fine-Tuning LLaMA-3.2 using ORPO and DPO for Human-Preference-Based Alignment [🔗](#)
- Quantization-Aware Reasoning and Text-to-SQL Agent Design using ReAct and LangGraph [🔗](#)
- ChatFood: Building a ReAct-based Conversational Food chatbot with LangGraph and Gemini [🔗](#)
- Conversational Search with RAG: Dataset Construction and Multifaceted Evaluation [🔗](#)
- Deep Learning for Sequence Labeling and Text Summarization with RNNs and Attention [🔗](#)
- Sentiment Classification of IMDB Reviews using Text Preprocessing and Classical IR Techniques [🔗](#)
- Relevance Classification using BERT for Query-Document Pairs in IR Tasks [🔗](#)
- Forecasting Community Dynamics in Social Graphs using Multi-Task GNNs [🔗](#)

Technical Skills

- **Soft Skills:** Teamwork, Mentoring & Teaching, Meeting Tight Deadlines, Cross-cultural Communication
- **Programming Languages:** Python
- **Large Language Models:** Hugging Face, LangChain, LangGraph, LangFuse, Unsloth, PEFT, Datasets, TRL
- **Databases:** SQL, LanceDB
- **Machine Learning:** PyTorch, Scikit-Learn, Evaluate, TensorFlow
- **Retrieval:** Sentence Transformers, Lexical Retrieval, Semantic Retrieval, BM25

Honors and Awards

- Ranked 14 in Nationwide Graduate Level University Entrance Test of Information Technology Engineering

Languages

- **Persian:** Native **English:** IELTS Academic 7/9